

UCSP

Understanding Culture, Society and Politics

Grade 12, Semester 1 study outline

A summary of section headings and key terms, made by students for revision. It is not the handout and does not replace it.

01. Introduction to Culture, Society, and Politics

I. Introduction

One learns that there are many belief systems, political views, religious sects and ways of life that are different

II. Anthropology, Sociology, and Political Science

According to Rasic (2018) from Arizona State University: People are shaped by the societies they are raised in. This

1. Archaeology deals with prehistoric societies by studying their tools and environment

III. What is the importance of Studying the Subject?

Basically, we study bits of anthropology in sociology. We study culture in sociology and anthropology. We learn

02. Introduction to Culture, Society, and Politics

I. Introduction

How do social scientists examine issues impacting human behavior? This course will focus on the questions social

II. Anthropological Perspectives

The concept of culture is anthropology's key concept. Besides the culture concept, however, anthropology also has

III. Sociological Perspectives

Sociologists would generally state that the profession is primarily focused on three theoretical orientations. These

A. Structural Functional Approach

This theoretical orientation views society as a complex interconnected system of parts that work together in

B. Symbolic - Interaction Approach

This theoretical orientation is considered a micro-level approach, which is an individual level approach. In

C. Conflict Approach

This theoretical orientation is considered a macro-level approach that focuses on inequality. Society is composed

IV. Political Science Perspectives

It studies the tendencies and actions of people which cannot be easily quantified or examined. Political

03. Culture and Society

I. Introduction

Are there rules for eating at McDonald's? Generally, we do not think about rules in a fast food restaurant, but if

II. Definition of Culture and Society

Culture and society are co-existent. one does not or cannot exist without the other. Culture and society may have

III. Characteristics of Culture

1. Culture is an Adaptive Mechanism

Over the last several hundred thousand years, we have developed new survival related cultural skills and

2. Culture is Learned

Culture is not innate in a person. It is also not biological in nature which means that it is not something that is

3. Culture is Shared

The culture that is learned across different societies is not possessed by a single person alone. The interaction of

4. Culture is Integrated

Cultural parts and aspects are interconnected in that when taken together, a way of life is manifested. When

5. Culture is adaptive and dynamic

Culture adapts to various environmental and geographical conditions as witnessed throughout the context of the

6. Culture is abstract

Culture is generally abstract. There is no single tangible manifestation that can take the form of culture itself. In

7. Culture is symbolic

Because culture is abstract, societies have developed a way by which concepts and ideas existing in the mind

Key terms

Culture and society - co-existent. one does not or cannot exist without the other. Culture and society may have

Society - combination of people with different cultures. On the other hand, Culture deal with the

Culture - considered an adaptive mechanism because it provides behavior patterns, strategies, and techniques

Cultural parts and aspects - interconnected in that when taken together, a way of life is manifested. When

Because culture - abstract, societies have developed a way by which concepts and ideas existing in the mind

04. Culture

I. Introduction

What are the rules when you pass an acquaintance at school, work, in the grocery store, or in the mall? Generally,

II. Elements of Culture

III. Variations/Concepts of Culture

Sociologists and anthropologists recognize the fact that culture is constantly evolving. Variations of culture are

A. Subculture

A Culture that lives within a culture. Most subcultures don't reject all of the values and practices of the larger

B. Counterculture

A subculture that rejects the values and norms of the larger society and replaces them with a new set of cultural

IV. Classification of Culture

It is important to understand that although culture is a system of ideals for behavior, there are instances when

A. Ideal Culture

It Refers to cultural guidelines publicly embraced by members of a society. Ideal Culture according to Crapo (2001)

B. Real Culture

Refers to the actual behavior of people in the society in their daily lives.

V. Vital Components of Culture

Though individual societies have varying histories, experiences, identities, and organizations, all of them have four

1. Symbols

Symbols are illustrations used to represent a particular

2. Language

It is a set of symbols that enables members of society to

3. Values

Broad ideas about what is good or desirable are shared by people in a society. Values are so general that they

4. Norms

Norms are the rules defining appropriate & inappropriate

A. Folkways

Are norms that don't have a great moral importance attached to them. They are the common customs of everyday

Key terms

Symbols - illustrations used to represent a particular

Language - probably the most obvious aspect of any culture - it allows us to create culture. The use of language is

Norms - rules defining appropriate & inappropriate

Even important norms - applied selectively - killing another person is applied differently to the military and the

05. Orientations in Viewing Other Cultures

I. Introduction

Cultures vary across various regions, both in material and non-material terms. The process of globalization has

II. Ethnocentrism

Ethnocentrism is the term anthropologists use to describe the opinion that one's own way of life is natural or

III. Xenocentrism

Conversely, there are some societies that have the tendency to consider their culture as inferior to others. This is

IV. Cultural Impact of Xenocentrism

In some extreme cases of xenocentrism, the impact on the local culture of its people favoring others' cultures can

Key terms

Ethnocentrism - term anthropologists use to describe the opinion that one's own way of life is natural or

Chopsticks - main utensils in China, Korea, Japan, and Vietnam and users regard them as superior to

Colonialism - social system in which the political conquests by one society of another leads to "cultural

Xenocentrism - culturally-based tendency to value other cultures more highly than one's own, which can

06. Cultural Relativism and Multiculturalism

I. Introduction

The Cross-Cultural Relationship is the idea that people from different cultures can have relationships that

II. Cultural Relativism

Cultural relativism is the ability to understand a culture on its own terms and not to make judgments using the

III. Multiculturalism

Multiculturalism describes the existence, acceptance, or promotion of multiple cultural traditions within a single

IV. Cultural Sensitivity

Instead of Cultural Relativism, some have advanced the concept of cultural sensitivity. Cultural sensitivity refers to

Key terms

Cultural relativism - ability to understand a culture on its own terms and not to make judgments using the

Culture - seen as an important element in building social capital and could also lead to future conflicts and

07. Identity and Personality Formation

I. Introduction

Have you ever wondered, "Bakit ako ganito? Bakit ganito ako makipag-usap sa ibang tao? Bakit ganito ako

II. Personality vs. Identity

Let us first define what Personality is, according to Iden (2018), Personality is something you were born with. It's a

III. Determinants of Personality Formation

Panopio (1994) suggested some determinants which influence the personality formation of the individual.

1. Biological Inheritance

Refers to the transmission from parents to offspring through the mechanisms of genes found in the chromosomes

2. Geographic Environment

It pertains to the places, climate, topography, and natural resources. People living in slum and squatter areas show

3. Cultural Environment

It refers to the learned ways of living, the norms of behavior- folkways, mores, laws, values, ideas, and partnered

4. Social Environment

Refers to the various groups and social interactions going on in the groups of which one is a member according to

08. Humanization and Homogenization

I. Introduction

Since the time Charles Darwin published his book, *On the Origin of Species*, in 1859 a revolutionary idea had

II. Homonization

We will start from *Homo Habilis* to *Homo Sapiens sapiens*.

III. Humanization

We have discovered the relation of biological human

A. Preindustrial Societies

Before the Industrial Revolution and the widespread use of machines, societies were small, rural, and dependent

1. Hunter-Gatherer

Hunter-gatherer societies demonstrate the strongest dependence on the environment of the various types of

2. Pastoral Society

Pastoral societies, such as the Maasai villagers, rely on the domestication of animals as a resource for survival.

3. Horticultural Society

Horticultural societies formed in areas where rainfall and other conditions allowed them to grow stable crops.

4. Agricultural Society

While pastoral and horticultural societies used small, temporary tools such as digging sticks or hoes, agricultural

5. Feudal Society

These societies contained a strict hierarchical system of power based around land ownership and protection. The

B. Industrial Society

In the eighteenth century, Europe experienced a dramatic rise in technological invention, ushering in an era known

C. Postindustrial or Information Societies

Information societies, sometimes known as postindustrial or digital societies, are a recent development. Unlike

Key terms

Evolution - not a thing of the past and is continuing even now. Humans are undergoing 'natural selection' for

Humanization - long process of improving the humans' everyday living through innovation, discovery

Digital technology - steam engine of information societies. Since the economy of information societies is

Social classes - divided by access to education, since without technical skills, people in an information society

09. Socialization, Statuses, and Roles

I. Introduction

affects personality. According to Morse (2013), Culture is one of the many factors that influence a person's

II. Socialization Process

The social process through which we develop our personalities and human potential and learn about our society

A. Primary Socialization - Your first experiences

with language, values, beliefs, behaviors, and norms of your society. An example of Primary Socialization is your

1. Anticipatory Socialization

The Social process where people learn to take on the values and standards of groups that they plan to join. Small

2. Gender Socialization

Learning with Psychological and Social traits associated with a person's sex. Gender Socialization starts from the

3. Race Socialization

It is the process through which children learn the behaviors, values, and attitudes associated with racial groups.

4. Class Socialization

It teaches the norms, values, traits, and behaviors you develop based on the social class you're in. This may help

III. Statuses and Roles

In all of the many social groups that we as individuals

A. Achieved and Acquired Statuses

The way in which people get our statuses can vary significantly in detail from culture to culture. In all societies,

B. Social Roles

Roles are duties performed by individuals depending on context. Once the word social is added, it is a broader

Key terms

Racial discrimination - partly the result of what parents teach their children about members of other races

Roles - duties performed by individuals depending on context. Once the word social is added, it is a broader

10. Agents of Socialization

I. Introduction

Socialization helps people learn to function successfully in their social worlds. How does the process of

II. Social Group Agents

Social groups often provide the first experiences of socialization. Families, and later peer groups, communicate

1. Family

Family is the first agent of socialization. Mothers and fathers, siblings and grandparents, plus members of an

2. Peer Groups

A peer group is made up of people who are similar in age and social status and who share interests.

III. Institutional Agents

The social institutions of our culture also inform our socialization. Formal institutions-like schools, workplaces,

1. School

Students are not in school only to study math, reading, science, and other subjects-the manifest function of this

2. Work

Just as children spend much of their day at school, many adults at some point invest a significant amount of time

3. Religion

While some religions are informal institutions, here we focus on practices followed by formal institutions. Religion

4. Government

Although we do not think about it, many of the rites of passage people go through today are based on age norms

5. Mass Media

Mass media distribute impersonal information to a wide audience, via television, newspapers, radio, and the

Key terms

Family - first agent of socialization. Mothers and fathers, siblings and grandparents, plus members of an

Students - not in school only to study math, reading, science, and other subjects-the manifest function of this

11. Social Processes

I. Introduction

Social processes are the ways in which individuals and groups interact, adjust and readjust and establish

II. Types of Social Processes

A. Enculturation

Growing up in any culture, all humans go through the process of enculturation. This process is the way in which

B. Acculturation

Acculturation is the process in which a person adapts to the influence of another culture by borrowing many of its

C. Assimilation

If acculturation implies immersion in another culture while maintaining one's mother culture, assimilation is a

D. Cooperation

Sociologists F.E. Merrill and H.W. Eldredge (1965) defined cooperation as "a form of social interaction wherein two

E. Differentiation

Differentiation is the process of designating each member of a society with particular functions and roles intended

F. Amalgamation

Cultural amalgamation is a term that refers to two or

G. Stratification

Sociologists use the term social stratification to describe the system of social standing. Social stratification refers to

H. Conflict

Conflict is an ever present process in human relations.

I. Competition

On the other hand, Competition is the struggle between two or more persons or groups that can be translated to

Key terms

Social processes - ways in which individuals and groups interact, adjust and readjust and establish

Interaction or mutual activity - essence of social life. Interaction between individuals and groups occurs in the

Acculturation - process in which a person adapts to the influence of another culture by borrowing many of its

Differentiation - process of designating each member of a society with particular functions and roles intended

Society's layers - made of people, and society's resources are distributed unevenly throughout the layers. The

Conflict - ever present process in human relations

Almost any human action - likely toward the hopes or interferes with the plans of someone else. Such action

12. Political-Leadership Structures and Social Control

I. Introduction

All societies impose social control on their citizens to some degree. They monitor and regulate behavior formally

II. Political and Leadership Structures

A political organization or political organization is any

III. Social Control

Sociologists define social control as the way that the norms, rules, laws, and structures of society regulate human

IV. Conformity

Conformity involves changing your behaviors in order to "fit in" or "go along" with the people around you.

Key terms

Hunting and gathering - their typical way of life. Social order is achieved through informal public opinion in the

State - community of persons. It is a human political

Social control - achieved through social, economic, and Without it, chaos and confusion would reign

13. Democratization, Human Dignity, Rights, the Common Good, and Education

I. Introduction

Everyone, it seems, wants to be democratic. There are even countries (such as Algeria, Congo, Ethiopia, Laos and

II. Democratization

When and where did Democracy begin? The first democracy historians know of was in Athens, Greece, around

III. Human Dignity, Rights, and the Common Good

A. What is a Political Community?

A political community is made up of a government that is accountable to its citizens, and citizens who live under

B. Human Dignity

Human dignity is an individual or group's sense of self-respect, self-worth, and physical and psychological integrity

C. Human Rights

Human rights are the basic rights every person has, simply because they are human. In the Philippines, these

D. Common Good

Working for the common good means making choices that benefit everyone, not just a few. When we create laws

IV. Education

Most people equate education with schools, but there is a huge difference between these two. Education refers to

Key terms

Human dignity - individual or group's sense of self-respect, self-worth, and physical and psychological integrity

Human rights - basic rights every person has, simply because they are human. In the Philippines, these

14. Groups and Variations

I. Introduction

Most of us use the word "group" without thinking much about it. In everyday conversations, it's a common and

II. Group

The term group is broad and can refer to a wide range of gatherings-from just two people (such as a "group

III. In-Groups and Out-Groups

One of the ways groups can exert influence is through the dynamics of inclusion and its opposite, exclusion. Being

IV. Reference Group

A reference group is a group that people use as a standard for evaluating themselves. We compare our behaviors,

15. Economic Institutions and Activities

I. Introduction in Economic Institutions

Economic institutions are organizations or systems responsible for the production and distribution of goods and

II. Reciprocity

It refers to the voluntary giving or taking of objects without the use of money in the hopes that, in the future, they

III. Transfers and the Government

Also known as government transfers or transfer payments, transfers refer to the redistribution of income or

IV. Redistribution

Redistribution occurs when individuals' goods or services are pooled together by a central authority to be stored

V. Types of State According to Market Roles

In these varying perspectives, the state plays different roles in relation to the market. There are at least three

A. Laissez-Faire State

Laissez-faire is derived from French words that mean "to leave alone." According to the principle of laissez-faire,

B. Interventionist or Developmental State

The developmental or interventionist state is a state that intervenes in the market and sets the direction and pace

C. Welfare State

The welfare state is one that plays an important role in the achievement and protection of the economic and

Key terms

Economic institutions - organizations or systems responsible for the production and distribution of goods and

Laissez-faire - derived from French words that mean "to leave alone." According to the principle of laissez-faire

16. Systems of Stratification

I. Introduction

Global stratification refers to the hierarchical arrangement of individuals and groups in societies around the world.

II. Perspectives on Stratification

III. Theories of Macro-Level Inequality

1. Class in Marxist Theory

In Marxist theory, the class structure of the capitalist mode of production is characterized by two main classes: the

2. Weberian Class

The class sociologist Max Weber formulated a three-component theory of stratification that saw political power as

Key terms

Global stratification - hierarchical arrangement of individuals and groups in societies around the world

Caste - elaborate and complex social system that combines some or all elements of endogamy, hereditary

Class - object of analysis for sociologists, political scientists, anthropologists and social historians. However

Sexism - discrimination against people based on their sex or gender, and can result in lower social status for

Sexist beliefs - example of essentialist thought, which holds that individuals can be understood (and often

17. Social Mobility and Change

I. Introduction

Social change refers to significant shifts in the structures, norms, and values of a society over time. These changes

II. Social Mobility

Social mobility refers to the movement of individuals or groups from one social position to another over time.

III. Types of Social Mobility

1. Horizontal Social Mobility

Horizontal social mobility refers to a change in position within the same social level or rank. For example, if a

2. Vertical Social Mobility

Vertical social mobility is of particular interest to sociologists because it involves a shift from one social class to

A. Intergenerational Mobility

This refers to a change in social position between generations within a family. For example, if a man works as a

B. Intragenerational Mobility

This refers to a change in an individual's social position over the course of their own lifetime. For instance, if a

IV. Social Change

Changes to technology, social institutions, population, and the environment, alone or in some combination, create

A. Technology

Some would say that improving technology has made our lives easier. Imagine what your day would be like

B. Social Institutions

Each change in a single social institution leads to changes in all social institutions. For example, the

C. Population

Population composition is changing at every level of society. Births increase in one nation and decrease in another.

D. The Environment

Turning to human ecology, we know that individuals and the environment affect each other. As human

V. Modernization

Modernization describes the processes that increase the amount of specialization and differentiation of structure

Key terms

Social change - significant shifts in the structures, norms, and values of a society over time. These changes

Social mobility - movement of individuals or groups from one social position to another over time

While it - most often associated with changes in wealth and social status, it can also involve shifts in health

Horizontal social mobility - change in position within the same social level or rank. For example, if a

Vertical social mobility - of particular interest to sociologists because it involves a shift from one social class to

Population composition - changing at every level of society. Births increase in one nation and decrease in another

18. Social Challenges, Contradictions, and Tensions

I. Introduction

Social Change can also underscore continual tensions and contradictions in society. What is tension? "It is one or

II. Forms of Social Tension

1. Religion

2. Oppression

3. Historical Grievances

4. Violations of International Law

5. Relative deprivation

6. Hatred of Global Economic Hegemony

7. Financial Gain

8. Racism

9. Guilt by association

10. Supporting sympathizers

11. Mortality Salience

12. Narcissism

Key terms

Civil disturbance - typically a symptom of, and a form of protest against, major socio-political problems; the

Contradictions and tensions - natural in a society of diverse people and culture